METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Product Safety & Quality Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Product Safety & Quality Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate ("MSCI")[1] outputs are determined. Product Safety & Quality is a Key Issue in the Social Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on their exposure to possible recalls or product safety concerns, the strength of their supply chain and sourcing systems, their quality management efforts in manufacturing and their responsible marketing practices.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to Section 2, Data, ratings and scores, of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Damage to brand value from loss of consumer trust or negative publicity.
- Increased costs to comply with additional regulatory requirements or litigation.
- Increased costs of implementing large-scale product recalls or to fulfill warranties.

Product Safety & Quality Key Issue score

The Product Safety & Quality Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Product Safety & Quality Management Framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Product Safety & Quality Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator

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to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

Component	Sustainability Indicator
Product Safety & Quality Practices score	Existence of contingency plans/mitigation control systems to ensure that products are in stock, reliable and safe
	Measures and reports quantitative indicators related to service quality performance or customer protection
	Certification to product safety or quality standard
	Scope of employee training on product quality
	Extent of product testing capacity
	Audit/control procedures on responsible marketing
	Policy on responsible marketing, advertising and sales
	Membership in recognized industry-wide partnership(s) on supply chain risk evaluation and mitigation
	Supplier certification level
	Scope of supplier training on quality standards
	Product responsibility & integrity
Product Safety & Quality Performance score	Regulatory warning performance relative to peers
	Warranty performance relative to peers
	Product recall performance relative to peers
	Industry-specific Product Safety and Quality Performance

Product Safety & Quality Management score

The Product Safety & Quality Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

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This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice, and 0 corresponding to lack of management. Refer to Section 3.3, Analyzing risk management, of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Product Safety & Quality Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

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The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Product Safety & Quality Practices score

Assesses the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks related to the strength of its supply chain and sourcing systems, its quality management efforts in manufacturing and its responsible marketing practices. This score is a component of the Product Safety & Quality Management score (excluding controversies) and considers attributes of the company's policies and initiatives. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Existence of contingency plans/mitigation control systems to ensure that products are in stock, reliable and safe**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has contingency plans/mitigation control systems to ensure that products are in stock, reliable, and safe.

- **Measures and reports quantitative indicators related to service quality performance or customer protection**

Definition: Indicates whether the company measures and reports quantitative indicators related to service quality performance or customer protection (e.g., clinical quality reports, customer surveys).

- **Certification to product safety or quality standard**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's products are certified to internationally recognized safety and quality standards. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

  - **Extent of certification to a widely accepted product safety/quality standard**

  Definition: Indicates whether the company certifies its own operations with a widely accepted product safety/quality standard (e.g., HACCP, ISO 9001, ISO/TS 16949, ISO 13485 or equivalent).

  - **Extent of certification to an internally developed product safety/quality standard**

  Definition: Indicates whether the company certifies its own operations with an internally developed product safety/quality standard.

- **Scope of employee training on product quality**

Definition: The scope of the company's employee training on product safety and quality. Best practice is for all employees to receive training on product quality standards.

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- **Extent of product testing capacity**

Definition: The extent of the company's product testing capacity, e.g., third-party or in-house testing.

- **Audit/control procedures on responsible marketing**

Definition: Indicates whether the company conducts audits or control procedures to assess compliance with its responsible marketing policies.

- **Policy on responsible marketing, advertising and sales**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has explicitly stated a policy on responsible marketing, advertising and sales.

- **Membership in recognized industry-wide partnership(s) on supply chain risk evaluation and mitigation**

Definition: Indicates whether the company is a member of industry initiatives or partnerships that evaluate supply chain risk and undertake relevant mitigation programs.

- **Supplier certification level**

Definition: Assesses whether suppliers at each level (e.g., Tier 1, Tier 2, Tier 3) possess relevant safety, and quality certifications. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

  - **General statement on supplier certification of quality procedures**

  Definition: Indicates whether the company makes general statements regarding the certification or oversight of its supply chain quality, without providing further detail on certification at specific levels of its supply chain

  - **Tier 1 - Direct supplier facilities and processes certified by company employees or third-party auditors**

  Definition: Indicates whether the company oversees the quality processes of its direct supplier (Tier 1) facilities and processes through certification or audits by a third party or by company employees.

  - **Tier 2 - Indirect/sub supplier facilities and processes certified by company employees or third-party auditors**

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Definition: Indicates whether the company oversees the quality processes of its indirect/sub-supplier (Tier 2) facilities and processes through certification or audits by a third party or by company employees.

- **Tier 3 - Ingredients/raw materials checked for quality on a regular basis**

Definition: Indicates whether the company oversees the quality processes of its ingredients/raw materials (Tier 3) through certification or audits by a third party or by company employees.

- **Scope of supplier training on quality standards**

Definition: The extent to which the company trains suppliers on quality standards, requirements, and processes. Best practice is to train all suppliers.

- **Product responsibility & integrity**

Definition: Assesses how responsibly and ethically a company designs, delivers and promotes its products and services. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

- **Medical Loss Ratio (MLR) performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's Medical Loss Ratio, reflecting the proportion of premiums spent on medical services versus administrative costs. Higher scores indicate stronger alignment with service quality and regulatory expectations in managed healthcare. Applicable to Managed Healthcare industry only.

- **Teaching staff score**

Definition: Assesses the proportion of teaching staff relative to the total workforce. Applicable to Education Services industry only.

- **Instruction to marketing expense ratio score**

Definition: Assesses the proportion of instruction and student services expenses to marketing and recruitment expenses. Applicable to Education Services industry only.

- **Marketing and recruitment expenses score**

Definition: Assesses the proportion of marketing expenses relative to the total sales revenue. Applicable to Education Services industry only.

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- **Responsible gambling policy & practices score**

Definition: Assesses the company's implementation of responsible gambling standards, policies, and player protection measures. Applicable to Casinos & Gaming industry only.

- **Antibiotics use policy score**

Definition: Assesses the company's policy framework and certifications related to antibiotic use in meat production and aquaculture. Applicable to Restaurants industry only.

- **Antibiotics phaseout targets**

Definition: Assesses the presence and robustness of issuer plans to phase out non-therapeutic or high-risk antibiotic use in meat production and aquaculture . Applicable to Restaurants industry only.

Product Safety & Quality Performance score

Assesses the company's performance on product safety & quality metrics (including recalls, regulatory warnings and/or warranty payments along with other industry specific metrics if applicable). Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Regulatory warning performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance based on number or regulatory warnings (warning letters and U.S. FDA form 483s ("Form 483")) and their intensities (normalized by sales) issued by regulatory authorities, relative to peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Industry relative warning letters performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on three-year average of total number of Warning Letters received (both absolute and sales normalized), relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average warning letters received (absolute)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average number of warning letters received.

- **Three-year average warning letters received (sales normalized)**

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Definition: Measures the company's three year average number of warning letters received, normalized by sales.

- **Industry relative Form 483 performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on three-year average of total number of Form 483s received (both absolute and sales normalized), relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average Form 483 received (absolute)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of absolute number of Form 483s received.

- **Three-year average Form 483 received (sales normalized)**

Definition: Measures the company's three year average number of Form 483 received, normalized by sales.

- **Warranty performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on warranty payments (normalized by sales) and its trend, relative to industry peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates

- **Warranty payments industry relative score**

Definition: Assesses the company's warranty payments intensity (per unit of sales or), relative to industry peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average warranty payments (per million revenue)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average warranty payments normalized by revenue.

- **Warranty Payments Industry Relative Trend score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average of year-over-year warranty payments intensity trend (per unit of sales), relative to industry peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average year-over-year warranty payments trend (per million revenue)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year change in warranty payments normalized by revenue.

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- **Product recall performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance with respect to product recalls, relative to industry peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

  - **Industry relative recalls performance score (absolute)**

    Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the total number of recalls, disaggregated by severity (severe, moderate, and minor), relative to industry peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

      - **Three-year average absolute total severe recalls**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of absolute total number of recalls that are severe in nature.

      - **Three-year average absolute total moderate recalls**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of absolute total number of recalls that are moderate in nature.

      - **Three-year average absolute total minor recalls**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of absolute total number of recalls that are minor in nature.

  - **Industry relative recalls performance score (sales based)**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on recall intensity normalized by sales, disaggregated by severity (severe, moderate, and minor), relative to industry peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

      - **Three-year average total severe recalls (sales based)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of total number of recalls that are moderate in nature normalized by sales.

      - **Three-year average total moderate recalls (sales based)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of total number of recalls that are moderate in nature normalized by sales.

      - **Three-year average total minor recalls (sales based)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of total number of recalls that are minor in nature normalized by sales.

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- **Automobile recalls performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's overall performance on recall intensity and trend metrics (vehicles recalled per vehicle manufactured or sold) relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance. Applicable to automobiles industry only.

- **Recalls per vehicle sales industry relative score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on vehicle-recall intensity metrics (vehicles recalled per vehicle sold), relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

- **Three-year average of recalls (normalized by number of vehicles sold)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of total number of recalls, normalized by number of vehicles sold.

- **Recalls per vehicle sales industry relative trend score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average year-over-year trend in vehicle-recall intensity (vehicles recalled per vehicle sold), relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

- **Three-year average of year-over-year trend in recalls (normalized by number of vehicles sold)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-trend in total number of recalls, normalized by number of vehicles sold.

- **Industry-specific Product Safety and Quality Performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on industry-specific metrics related to product safety and quality. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

- **Airworthiness directives performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on compliance with airworthiness directives issued by aviation regulators over a three-year period relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance. Applicable to Aerospace & Defense companies with revenues in Aircrafts segments only.

- **Industry Relative airworthiness directives intensity score**

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Definition: Assesses the company's performance on airworthiness-directive intensity metrics (number of airworthiness directives per sales) relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average airworthiness directives intensity**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average number of airworthiness directives normalized by sales.

- **Air incidents performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on aviation incidents leading to fatalities and damage caused to the aircraft due to aviation incidents. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance. Applicable to Passenger airlines industry only.

- **Aviation Incidents Fatality score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on number of fatalities due to air incidents. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

- **Three-year average number of fatalities**

Definition: Measures the company's three year average number of fatalities caused due to aviation incidents.

- **Industry Relative Aircraft Damage intensity score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on damage caused to the aircraft intensity (normalized by sales), relative to peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

- **Three-year average aircraft damage intensity**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of aircrafts damaged intensity (normalized by sales) due to aviation incidents.

- **Managed healthcare performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on healthcare plan quality and safety metrics based on CMS Star Ratings or IDSS scores. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance. Applicable to managed healthcare industry only.

- **Water quality standards score**

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Definition: Assesses the company's performance on compliance with drinking-water-quality standards and regulations. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance. Applicable to water utilities industry only.

- **Labelling or marketing incidents performance score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on compliance with industry or regulatory labeling and marketing codes. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance. Applicable to Beverages industry only.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Product safety and quality controversies.
- Customer fraud and billing controversies.
- False marketing controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to Section 3.3.2, Controversies cases, of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Product Safety & Quality Exposure score

The Product Safety & Quality Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business Exposure score only. The Business Exposure score is scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to Section 3.2, Analyzing risk exposure, of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

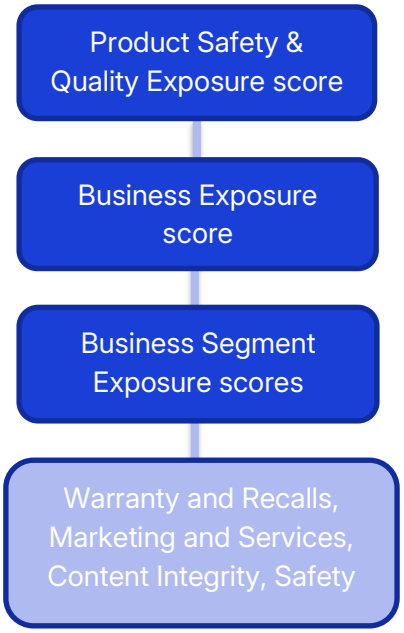
$$EXP_{PSQ,i} = BUS_{PSQ,i}$$

Where:

- $EXP_{PSQ,i}$ is the Product Safety & Quality Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{PSQ,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.

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Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. Scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each business segment, using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{PSQ,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,j} BSE_{PSQ,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{PSQ,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure score

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of business segments as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business

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Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is calculated as the maximum of the Warranty and Recalls score, Marketing and Services score, Retail score, Content Integrity score and Safety score of a business activity:

$$BSE_{PSQ,j} = \max\left(W\&R_j,\ M\&S_j,\ CIS_j,\ SS_j\right)$$

Where:

- $W\&R_j$ is the Warranty and Recalls score for business activity j.
- $M\&S_j$is the Marketing and Services score for business activity j.
- CIS_j is the Content Integrity score for business activity j.
- SS_j is the Safety score for business activity j.

The Warranty and Recalls score is calculated as the average of the Warranty score, Safety Regulator score and Recalls score. The Warranty score is calculated from the average warranty reserve ratio (warranty reserves/total assets). The Safety Regulator score is developed from a qualitative assessment of whether a business activity is regulated in the United States by the FDA, the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) or Federal Aviation Administration. The Recalls score is calculated from the number of recalls for each business activity.

The Marketing and Services score is a qualitative assessment depending on (1) whether the business activity is regulated in the United States by the Federal Trade Commission's (FTC's) bureau for marketing and advertising regulations and (2) whether the business activity provides services or products that have addictive properties.

The Content Integrity score is a qualitative assessment of the integrity of the information provided by business activities and is specific to media outlets.

The Safety score is calculated from annual death rates attributable to select business activities that carry health risks (e.g., through injury, contamination or intoxication).

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine Product Safety & Quality scores:

Jayant R. Kale, et al., 2013, "Contracting with Nonfinancial Stakeholders and Corporate Capital Structure: The Case of Product Warranties," *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis* 48, no. 3: 699-727; Consumer Product Safety Commission; FDA; Department of Agriculture; NHTSA; FTC; Refinitiv; Food and Drug Administration (US); Medicines & Healthcare Products Regulatory Agency (UK); Health Canada (Canada); National Medical Products Administration (China), European Medicine Agency (EU), Therapeutics Good Administration (Australia); Pharmaceuticals and Medical Devices Agency (Japan); Medicines and Medical Devices Safety Authority (New Zealand); Drug Office (Hong Kong); Ministry of Food and Drug Safety (Korea); Swiss Agency for Therapeutic Products (Switzerland), National Agency for the Safety of Medicine and Health Products (France); Federal Institute for Drugs and Medical Devices

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(Germany); Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) (US); Índice de Desempenho da Saúde Suplementar (IDSS) (Brazil); Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) (US); European Union Aviation Safety Agency (EASA) (EU); The Flight Safety Foundation Aviation Safety Network (ASN); MSCI S&C; company disclosures.

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